PHINMA Araullo University - South
College of Information Technology
Bachelor of Science in Information Technology
S.Y. 2026-2027 | First Semester

ITE 381 IT Business Solution | Period 1 Requirements

Project Documentation about: NEUST Enrollment Portal

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I. Empathize – Interview a Real User

The user shared their actual experience using the NEUST enrollment portal. They normally access the portal on their scheduled enrollment date and complete different requirements, including personal, academic, health, and other student information.

The main difficulties they experienced were the **portal becoming slow, unresponsive, or crashing when many students use it at the same time**. In some cases, the user had to wait **one to two hours** to complete the enrollment. When the system crashes, they may need to refresh the page, log in again, or repeat information they already entered.

The user also said that completing the many required information fields takes time, especially when the portal is already slow. When problems happen, they usually try to fix them by waiting, refreshing, logging in again, and checking their internet connection.

Overall, the interview shows that the enrollment process can be **time-consuming and frustrating because of system slowdowns, crashes, and the possibility of losing entered information**.

II. Define – Identify the Real Problem

Identify the Real Problem

The real problem is that **NEUST students experience a slow and unreliable online enrollment portal**, especially when many students use it at the same time. The system may become unresponsive or crash, forcing students to refresh the page, log in again, or repeat information. This causes **long waiting times, wasted time, frustration, and difficulty completing enrollment on time**.

Target User:

NEUST students who use the online enrollment portal.

User's Need:

Students need a smooth and reliable enrollment process where they can complete and submit their required information without experiencing long waiting times or losing their progress.

Root Cause of the Problem:

The enrollment portal becomes slow, crashes, or becomes unresponsive when many students access the system at the same time. Students also have to enter many types of information, which makes the process longer.

Impact of the Problem:

Students may spend around **one to two hours** completing enrollment. They may need to refresh the page, log in again, or repeat parts of the process when the system crashes, causing frustration, wasted time, and anxiety about completing enrollment within the scheduled period.

Our Problem Statement:

NEUST students need a smooth and reliable enrollment process because the enrollment portal becomes slow, crashes, or becomes unresponsive when many students access it at the same time, resulting in long waiting times, repeated work, frustration, and difficulty completing enrollment within the scheduled period.

III. Ideate – Generate a Solution

Following the Design Thinking framework, this phase transforms the identified problem into opportunities for improvement by generating potential solutions and selecting the most effective one to develop.

Based on the Problem Statement from Chapter 2, the following How Might We (HMW) question was developed to explore ways to improve the student's situation without immediately focusing on a single specific solution:

Our HMW Question:

How might we improve the NEUST online enrollment portal to ensure a faster, more reliable, and user-friendly process for students even during peak enrollment periods?

Drawing from the user's suggestions and the identified pain points, here are three possible solutions:

#	Solution Idea	How will it help solve the problem
1.	**Improved server capacity**	**it will prevent the portal from crashing or slowing down when many students access it simultaneously.**
2.	**Simplified data entry and form design**	**it will reduce the time needed to complete enrollment.**
3.	**Progress tracking and clear navigation**	**It will guide students smoothly through each step.**

After reviewing the options, the group has selected the following solution to develop:

Selected Solution: Improved server capacity

- **Why did you choose this solution?**

  We chose to improve the server capacity because it directly fixes the main issue of the portal slowing down or crashing when many students use it at the same time. With stronger servers, the system can handle more users without problems.

- **How will it help the user?**

  This makes the enrollment process faster, smoother, and less stressful for students that are struggling. It is also realistic for our group to work since it focuses on technical improvements that are doable within our project.

Project Direction:

We propose to develop to help improve NEUST online enrollment portal with upgraded server capacity to help students enroll quickly and smoothly without system crashes or delays.

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